“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 5

The Divine Majesty of Śrī Nityānanda

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I worship Śrī Nityānanda, the Lord, whose opulence is unlimited and wonderful. By His will even an ignorant person can come to understand His true nature.

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In these six verses I have told the glory of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. In five verses I now tell the truth about Nityānanda in its full extent.

4 Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, is the Supreme Lord Himself (*svayaṁ bhagavān*). Śrī Balarāma is His second body.

5 Both are one and the same in nature; only Their bodies differ. Balarāma is the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa's body (*kāya-vyūha*) and His helper in His pastimes.

6 That Kṛṣṇa is Śrī Caitanya-candra in Navadvīpa, and that Balarāma is Śrī Nityānanda, who is always with Him.

7 “Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī, Kṣīrodakaśāyī and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions. May that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my shelter.” (Svarūpa Dāmodara’s diary)

8 Śrī Balarāma Gosāñi is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. Assuming five forms, He serves Kṛṣṇa.

9 In His own person He assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes, and assuming four other forms, He carries out the work of the pastime of creation.

10 Creation and the rest are His service: in them He carries out Kṛṣṇa's order. And in the form of Śeṣa He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways.

11 In all these forms He relishes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. That same Balarāma is Nityānanda, the companion of Gaura.

12 I have explained the meaning of the seventh verse in four verses, so that the whole world may know the truth about Nityānanda.

13 “Beyond māyā lies the all-pervading realm of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence. There, among the four divine *vyūhas*, His form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines forth. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.” (Svarūpa Dāmodara’s diary)

14 Beyond material nature lies the abode called Paravyoma, the spiritual sky. Like Kṛṣṇa's own form, it is endowed with opulence and every other excellence.

15 The supreme Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes there are all-pervading and unlimited. In them Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras reside.

16 In its uppermost region is the realm renowned as Kṛṣṇaloka. It exists in three divisions: Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

17 Highest of all is Śrī Gokula, the abode of Vraja. It is also called Śrī Goloka, Śvetadvīpa and Vṛndāvana.

18 Like Kṛṣṇa's own body, it is all-pervading, unlimited and vast. It extends above and below, and it has no limit.

19 By Kṛṣṇa's will it is manifested within the material universe as well. Yet its nature is one and the same; it does not have two bodies.

20 Its ground is touchstone (*cintāmaṇi*), and its forests are full of wish-fulfilling trees. But fleshly eyes see it as no different from the material world.

21 Only with eyes of love does one see it as it truly is — the place where Kṛṣṇa enjoys His pastimes with the cowherd boys and girls.

22 “I worship Govinda, the original Person, who tends the *surabhi* cows in abodes built of countless touchstones and surrounded by millions of wish-fulfilling trees. Hundreds of thousands of goddesses of fortune serve Him with loving reverence.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.29)

23 In Mathurā and Dvārakā He manifests His own form. Becoming the four *vyūhas* (*catur-vyūha*), He enjoys pastimes there in many forms.

24 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the source of all other *catur-vyūhas*. They are transcendent (*turīya*) and pure.

25 In these three abodes Kṛṣṇa is wholly absorbed in pastimes. With His own associates He plays there eternally.

26 In the spiritual sky He manifests His own form as Nārāyaṇa and enjoys pastimes of many kinds.

27 Kṛṣṇa's original form has only two arms; in the form of Nārāyaṇa that same body has four.

28 He holds the conch, disc, club and lotus, and He is full of supreme opulence. His potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā serve His feet.

29 Although His nature is to engage in pastimes alone, out of mercy He does one thing for the souls:

30 He delivers them by granting four kinds of liberation: *sālokya* (living in His abode), *sāmīpya* (nearness to Him), *sārṣṭi* (opulence like His) and *sārūpya* (a form like His).

31 Those who attain liberation by merging into Brahman (*sāyujya*) have no access there; they remain outside Vaikuṇṭha.

32 Outside Vaikuṇṭha is a region of light. It is the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body, supremely brilliant.

33 It is called Siddhaloka, and it lies beyond material nature. It is spiritual in nature, but the spiritual potency displays no variety there.

34 It is like the disc of the sun: from outside the sun appears featureless, but within it there is variety — the sun-god's chariot and all the rest.

35 “As one reaches Him by fixing the mind on the Lord with devotion, so many have fixed their minds on Him through lust, hatred, fear or affection, cast off their sin and reached that same goal.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.1.30)

36 “It is said that the goal of the Lord's enemies and of His beloved devotees is as if one and the same. This is because Brahman and Kṛṣṇa are one, as the rays and the sun are one.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.278)

37 In the same way, within the spiritual sky the spiritual potency displays pastimes of every variety, while outside it a featureless sphere of light is manifest.

38 That featureless Brahman is nothing but light. Those who are fit for *sāyujya* attain absorption in it.

39 “Beyond darkness lies Siddhaloka. There reside the perfected beings (*siddhas*), immersed in the bliss of Brahman, and the demons slain by Hari.” (Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa)

40 In that spiritual sky, on Nārāyaṇa's four sides, the *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā is present in a second manifestation.

41 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — this is the second *catur-vyūha*. They too are transcendent and pure.

42 Rāma's form there is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is the shelter of the spiritual potency and the cause of all causes.

43 One display of the spiritual potency is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure being. All the abodes, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest, are made of *śuddha-sattva*.

44 The six kinds of opulence there are all spiritual. Know for certain that all of them are the glory of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

45 There is one potency called marginal (*taṭasthā*); it is named *jīva*. Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all the souls.

46 Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of that Puruṣa from whom the universe arises and into whom it dissolves.

47 He is the shelter of all and wonderful in every way, and His opulence is boundless. Even Ananta cannot describe His glory.

48 That transcendent One, made of pure being and named Saṅkarṣaṇa, is a portion of Nityānanda-Rāma.

49 I have briefly explained the eighth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the ninth.

50 “The blessed Puruṣa, the original Lord and the master of māyā, whose body shelters the multitude of universes, lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean. He is but one portion of Nityānanda. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.” (Svarūpa Dāmodara’s diary)

51 Outside Vaikuṇṭha lies the abode of light, and beyond it lies what is called the Kāraṇārṇava, the Causal Ocean.

52 Surrounding Vaikuṇṭha is an ocean, endless and shoreless, without any limit.

53 In Vaikuṇṭha the earth and all the other elements are spiritual. No material element ever arises there.

54 That spiritual water is the supreme cause. The Gaṅgā, purifier of the fallen, is a single drop of it.

55 In that Causal Ocean, the same Saṅkarṣaṇa lies in one of His portions.

56 He is the Puruṣa, the creator of the *mahat-tattva* and the cause of the world. This first avatāra casts His glance upon māyā.

57 The potency called māyā remains outside the Causal Ocean; māyā cannot touch its waters.

58 That māyā exists in two aspects. As the material ingredient of the world, she is called *pradhāna* or *prakṛti*.

59 Prakṛti, inert by nature, cannot be the cause of the world. Kṛṣṇa shows her mercy by infusing her with His potency.

60 By Kṛṣṇa's potency prakṛti becomes a secondary cause, just as iron burns by the power of fire.

61 Therefore Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the world. Prakṛti is a cause only in the way the nipples on a goat's neck are nipples.

62 In her aspect as māyā she is called the efficient cause. But she is not that either, for the agent who acts as the cause is Nārāyaṇa.

63 As the potter is the efficient cause of a pot, so the Puruṣa-avatāra is the maker of the world.

64 Kṛṣṇa is the maker, and māyā merely assists Him, as the wheel, the rod and the other instruments assist in making a pot.

65 From afar the Puruṣa glances at māyā and places in her the seed in the form of the souls.

66 Only a reflection of His body comes into contact with māyā, and from māyā multitudes of universes are then born.

67 However many universes there are, countless and unlimited, in so many forms the Puruṣa enters them all.

68 When the breath goes out from the Puruṣa's nostrils, the universes become manifest with His exhalation.

69 And when the breath enters Him again, the universes enter the Puruṣa's body with it.

70 As specks of dust move through the openings of a lattice window, so swarms of universes move through the pores of the Puruṣa's skin.

71 “The lords of the universes, born from the pores of His skin, live only for the duration of one of His exhalations. He is Mahā-Viṣṇu, and He is a particular part of Govinda, the original Person, whom I worship.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.48)

72 “What am I, with a body seven spans tall, inside the pot of a universe enclosed by darkness, the *mahat*, false ego, ether, air, fire, water and earth? And what is Your greatness? Through the pores of Your skin countless such universes move like specks of dust through the openings of a window.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.11)

73 A portion of a portion is called a *kalā*. Śrī Balarāma is Govinda's counterpart.

74 One of His forms is Śrī Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, and His portion, the Puruṣa, is counted as a *kalā*.

75 The one I call a *kalā* is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the great Puruṣa, the source of avatāras, victorious over all.

76 Garbhodaśāyī and Kṣīrodaśāyī are both called Puruṣas. Those two are portions of Him — Viṣṇu, the abode of the universes.

77 “Viṣṇu has three forms, known as the Puruṣas. The first creates the *mahat-tattva*, the second lies within the universe, and the third dwells in all beings. One who knows them is liberated.” (Sātvata-tantra; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa 2.9)

78 Although I call Him a *kalā* of Kṛṣṇa, He is the source of Matsya, Kūrma and the other avatāras.

79 “All these are portions and parts of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring relief to the world when it is troubled by

the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28)

80 That Puruṣa creates, maintains and dissolves the universe. He descends as many avatāras, for He is the sustainer of the world.

81 The portion that descends for creation and the rest is called an avatāra.

82 The great Puruṣa is the first avatāra and Bhagavān. He is the seed of all avatāras, the abode where all find shelter.

83 "The Puruṣa is the first avatāra of the Supreme. Time, nature, cause and effect, the mind, the elements, false ego, the modes, the senses, the universal form (*virāṭ*), the independent one (*svarāṭ*), and all beings, unmoving and moving, are manifestations of the Great One." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.6.42)

84 "In the beginning, desiring to create the worlds, Bhagavān manifested the form of the Puruṣa, together with the *mahat-tattva* and the other elements — sixteen parts in all." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.1)

85 He is the shelter of all, and the material world rests in Him. As the indwelling Self (*antarātmā*) He is also the support of the world.

86 Thus He is related to prakṛti in both ways, yet He has not the faintest trace of contact with her.

87 "This is the divinity of the Lord: although He is within material nature, He is never touched by its qualities, though they always rest in Him. In the same way the intelligence of those who take shelter of Him remains untouched by them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.11.38)

88 The Gītā too says again and again that the Lord, by His very nature, always possesses inconceivable power:

89 “I dwell in the world, and the world rests in Me. Yet I do not dwell in the world, nor does the world rest in Me.

90 Know this to be My inconceivable opulence.” This is the meaning of the Gītā, now made known.

91 He of whom that Puruṣa is called a portion is Nityānanda-Rāma, the companion of Śrī Caitanya.

92 This is the explanation of the ninth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the tenth.

93 “The blessed Garbhodakaśāyī is a portion of His portion. The lotus from His navel has a stem that holds the multitude of worlds, and it is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.” (Svarūpa Dāmodara’s diary)

94 Having created unlimited universes, that Puruṣa became many forms and entered them all.

95 Entering within, He saw only darkness, with no place to stay, and He reflected on this.

96 He created water from the perspiration of His own body, and with that water He filled half the universe.

97 The universe measures five hundred million *yojanas*; its length and breadth are the same.

98 Filling half of it with water, He made His dwelling there, and in the other half He manifested the fourteen worlds.

99 There He manifested Vaikuṇṭha, His own abode, and He rested upon the waters on the bed of Śeṣa.

100–101 There He lay down on Ananta as His bed. He has a thousand heads and a thousand faces, a thousand feet and hands and a thousand eyes. He is the seed of all avatāras and the cause of the world.

102 From His lotus navel arose a lotus, and that lotus became the birthplace of Brahmā.

103 Within the stem of that lotus the fourteen worlds came to be. Then, becoming Brahmā, He brought forth the creation.

104 Taking the form of Viṣṇu, He protects the world. Viṣṇu is beyond the modes of nature and has no contact with the modes of māyā.

105 Taking the form of Rudra, He destroys the world. Creation, maintenance and dissolution all take place by His will.

106 He is Hiraṇyagarbha, the indwelling Lord and the cause of the world. The universal form (*virāṭ*) is conceived as a portion of Him.

107 Such is Nārāyaṇa, and He is a portion of a portion of Lord Nityānanda, the crown jewel of all.

108 I have explained the meaning of the tenth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the eleventh.

109 “Viṣṇu who lies in the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings, is a portion of a portion of His portion. Ananta, who upholds the earth, is also His part. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.” (Svarūpa Dāmodara’s diary)

110 Within the stem from Nārāyaṇa's navel lies the earth, and within the earth are the seven oceans that are counted.

111 There, in the midst of the Ocean of Milk, is the island called Śvetadvīpa. It is the abode of Viṣṇu, the maintainer.

112 He is the indwelling Supersoul of all beings. He maintains the world and is its master.

113 In every *yuga* and *manvantara* He assumes various avatāras, establishing religion and destroying irreligion.

114 The gods cannot see Him, so they go to the shore of the Ocean of Milk and offer Him prayers.

115 Then He descends and protects the world. His opulences are unlimited and beyond counting.

116 That Viṣṇu is a portion of a portion of a portion of Lord Nityānanda, the crown jewel of all.

117 In the form of Śeṣa that Viṣṇu holds up the earth, yet He does not even know where on His heads it rests.

118 His thousand broad hoods spread in a circle, and on them hosts of jewels glitter more brightly than the sun.

119 The earth, fifty crores of *yojanas* in extent, rests on one of His hoods like a mustard seed.

120 That Ananta Śeṣa is the avatāra who appears as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*). He knows nothing but service to the Lord.

121 With His thousand mouths He sings the qualities of Kṛṣṇa. He sings them without cease, yet never reaches their end.

122 Sanaka and the other Kumāras hear the Bhāgavatam from His mouth. He tells the qualities of the Lord and floats in the joy of love.

123 Umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, resting place, dwelling, sacred thread and throne —

124 in all these different forms He serves Kṛṣṇa. Having become Kṛṣṇa's *śeṣa*, one who exists wholly for Him, He bears the name Śeṣa.

125 That Ananta, I say, is but one portion of Him. Such is Lord Nityānanda — who can know His play?

126 By all these proofs I know the full extent of the truth about Nityānanda. I call Him Ananta — but what glory of His does that express?

127 Or else I accept the words of the devotees as true: everything is possible in Him, since He is the source of the avatāras.

128 Those who know understand that an avatāra and the source of the avatāras are not different. So it was before, when people regarded Kṛṣṇa as one avatāra or another.

129 Some said Kṛṣṇa was Nara-Nārāyaṇa Himself; others said Kṛṣṇa was Vāmana Himself.

130 Still others said that Kṛṣṇa was the avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. None of this is impossible; the words of all of them are true.

131 When Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all portions, descends, all His portions come and unite in Him.

132 Each describes Him in the form in which he knows Him. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa; nothing of it is false.

133 Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi performed the pastimes of all the avatāras and showed them to everyone.

134 In this way Nityānanda is manifest as Ananta, and in that mood He says, “I am Caitanya's servant.”

135 Sometimes He plays as the Lord's guru, sometimes as His friend, sometimes as His servant — just as before, in Vraja, He played in these three moods.

136 Becoming a bull, He would fight with Kṛṣṇa head to head; and sometimes Kṛṣṇa would massage His feet.

137 Considering Himself a servant, He knows Kṛṣṇa as His master and regards Himself as a portion of a portion of Kṛṣṇa.

138 “Pretending to be bulls and bellowing, the two fought each other; imitating the cries of the animals, They roamed about like ordinary boys.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.11.40)

139 “Sometimes, when His elder brother was tired from play and lay with His head on a cowherd boy's lap, Kṛṣṇa Himself would refresh Him by massaging His feet and with other services.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.15.14)

140 [Balarāma thought:] “Who is she, and where has she come from? Is she divine, human or demonic? Most likely she is the māyā of My master, Kṛṣṇa; no other could bewilder even Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.13.37)

141 [Baladeva said:] “The rulers of all the worlds bear the dust of His lotus feet on their finest crowns; that dust is worshiped as the holy place of all holy places. Brahmā, Śiva, I Myself and Śrī, the goddess of fortune, are portions of His portion, and we carry it on our heads forever. What, then, is a king's throne to Him?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.68.37)

142 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord; all others are His servants. As He makes each one dance, so each one dances.

143 In the same way Caitanya Gosāñi alone is the Lord; all others are His associates or His servants.

144–145 His elders — Nityānanda, Advaita Ācārya, Śrīvāsa and others — and all the rest, whether younger, equal or senior, are His associates and helpers in His pastimes. With all of them Lord Gaura accomplishes His purpose.

146 Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda are His two limbs. With these two the Lord enjoys all His pastimes.

147 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord Himself. Mahāprabhu honors Him as His guru, yet Advaita is His servant.

148 The truth of Ācārya Gosāñi cannot be told. He brought Kṛṣṇa down and delivered the world.

149 Formerly Nityānanda Svarūpa became Lakṣmaṇa and, as His younger brother, served Rāma.

150 All of Rāma's deeds were a source of sorrow, and in those pastimes, which Rāma chose freely, Lakṣmaṇa bore the sorrow.

151 Being the younger brother, He could not object. Lakṣmaṇa kept silent and bore the pain within His heart.

152 When Kṛṣṇa descended, He became the elder brother in order to serve Him, and He made Kṛṣṇa taste many kinds of joy.

153 Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa are particular portions of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. At the time of the descent the two enter into these two.

154 Because of these portions the two take the roles of elder and younger brother, while scripture explains Them as the portion and the source of the portion.

155 “I worship Govinda, the original Person, who, abiding in His portions in Rāma and other forms, descended in many avatāras in the worlds, but who Himself appeared as Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Person.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.39)

156 Śrī Caitanya is that Kṛṣṇa, and Nityānanda is Balarāma. Nityānanda fulfills all of Caitanya's desires.

157 The ocean of Nityānanda's glory is endless and without a shore. I have touched only one drop of it, and that only by His mercy.

158 Hear one more glory of His mercy: He raised a fallen soul to the highest limit.

159 It is not fitting to tell this account, which is as hidden as the Vedas. Still I tell it, to reveal His mercy.

160 In overflowing joy I write of Your grace. O Lord Nityānanda, forgive my offense!

161 Avadhūta Gosāñi had a servant who was an abode of love. His name was Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

162 In my house there was *saṅkīrtana* day and night, and he came to it at my invitation.

163 Filled with great love, he sat in the courtyard, and all the Vaiṣṇavas bowed at his feet.

164 As they offered him obeisances, in his love he would climb on one man's back, strike another with his flute, and slap another.

165 From his eyes flowed an unbroken stream of tears, and whoever saw those eyes had tears in his own heart.

166 Sometimes I saw the hair on some limb of his body stand erect like the buds of a *kadamba* flower; one limb would be stiff, while another trembled.

167 When he called out “Nityānanda!” with a loud roar, the people who saw it were struck with wonder.

168 A respectable brāhmaṇa named Guṇārṇava Miśra was serving near the Deity.

169 When Rāmadāsa came into the courtyard, the brāhmaṇa did not greet him. Seeing this, Rāmadāsa became angry and said:

170 “Here is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta, who did not rise to greet Baladeva when he saw Him!”

171 Having said this, he danced and sang in delight. The brāhmaṇa was engaged in Kṛṣṇa's service, and so he showed no anger.

172 When the festival was over, he bestowed his blessings and was about to leave. Then a dispute arose between him and my brother.

173 My brother had firm faith in Lord Caitanya, but toward Nityānanda he had only a semblance of faith.

174 Knowing this, Rāmadāsa was pained at heart. Then I rebuked my brother:

175 “The two brothers are one body and equal manifestations. If you do not honor Nityānanda, you will be ruined.

176 You have faith in one, but you show no respect to the other. Your standard is the logic of half a hen (*ardha-kukkuṭī-nyāya*).

177 Better reject both and be an unbeliever. Accepting one and rejecting the other — that is hypocrisy.”

178 Rāmadāsa broke his flute in anger and left. At that very moment my brother's ruin was complete.

179 Thus I have told the power of His servant. Now I tell one more thing, about the nature of His compassion.

180 I had rebuked my brother, and, taking this as a merit in me, the Lord appeared to me that very night.

181 In the village named Jhāmaṭapura, near Naihāṭi, Nityānanda-Rāma appeared to me in a dream.

182 I fell at His feet like a rod, and the Lord placed His own lotus feet on my head.

183 “Get up, get up!” He told me again and again. When I rose and saw His form, I was struck with wonder.

184 His complexion was dark and glossy, His body massive. He was Kandarpa, the god of love, in person, and like a mighty wrestler and hero.

185 His hands and feet were shapely and His eyes like lotuses. He wore silk on His head and was dressed in silk.

186 Golden earrings hung from His ears; He wore golden armlets and bracelets. Anklets jingled on His feet, and a garland of flowers hung around His neck.

187 His body was smeared with sandalwood paste, and His *tilaka* was graceful. His slow gait, heavy with intoxication, surpassed that of an intoxicated elephant.

188 His face, brighter than millions of moons, shone with radiant color. He was chewing betel, and His teeth were like pomegranate seeds.

189 Intoxicated with love, His body swayed right and left, and in a deep voice He called, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”

190 With a red staff in His hand He swayed like a maddened lion, and bees surrounded His feet on all sides.

191 I saw His associates, all in the dress of cowherds. All were calling, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” absorbed in love.

192 Some played horns and flutes; some danced and sang. A servant offered betel, and another waved a *cāmara*.

193 So I beheld the splendor of Nityānanda Svarūpa. What form, what qualities, what pastimes — all beyond this world!

194 Overwhelmed with bliss, I was aware of nothing. Then the Lord smiled and spoke to me:

195 “O Kṛṣṇadāsa, do not be afraid! Go to Vṛndāvana; there you will attain everything.”

196 Saying this, He sent me off with a sign of His hand, and the Lord disappeared together with His associates.

197 I fell unconscious to the ground. Then the dream broke, and I saw that morning had come.

198 I reflected on what I had seen and heard: the Lord had ordered me to go to Vṛndāvana.

199 That very moment I set out for Vṛndāvana, and by the Lord's mercy I reached Vṛndāvana happily.

200 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, to Nityānanda-Rāma, by whose mercy I attained the abode of Vṛndāvana!

201 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to the merciful Lord, from whom I attained the shelter of Rūpa and Sanātana!

202 From Him I attained the great soul Raghunātha; from Him I attained the shelter of Śrī Svarūpa.

203 By Sanātana's mercy I attained the conclusions of *bhakti*; by Śrī Rūpa's mercy I attained the furthest reaches of *bhakti-rasa*.

204 Glory, glory to the lotus feet of Nityānanda, by which I attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda!

205 I am more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi, and lower than a worm in excrement.

206 Whoever hears my name loses his pious merit; whoever utters my name incurs sin.

207 Who in all the world would show mercy to someone as despicable as me, except Nityānanda alone?

208 Nityānanda, intoxicated with love, is the avatāra of mercy. He makes no distinction between the high and the low.

209 Whoever falls before Him, He delivers. Therefore He delivered even a wicked person like me.

210 He brought me, the most sinful, to Śrī Vṛndāvana, and to a fallen soul like me He gave the feet of Śrī Rūpa.

211 The sight of Śrī Madana-gopāla and Śrī Govinda — all this is not fit to be told.

212 Śrī Madana-gopāla is the lord of Vṛndāvana. He enjoys the *rāsa* dance; He is the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

213 With Śrī Rādhā and Lalitā He enjoys the *rāsa* pastime, manifest in the form that bewilders even Cupid.

214 "Śauri appeared among them, His lotus face smiling. Wearing yellow garments and a garland, He was Himself the bewilderer of Cupid." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.32.2)

215 By His own sweetness He attracts the minds of all. On His two sides Rādhā and Lalitā serve Him.

216 Nityānanda's mercy showed Him to me; it gave me Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana as my Lord.

217 It gave me, a fallen soul, the sight of Śrī Govinda. That is not a thing to be told; it is beyond words.

218–219 In Vṛndāvana, at the Yogapīṭha, in a grove of wish-fulfilling trees, there is a jeweled pavilion. On a jeweled throne there sits Śrī Govinda, the son of the king of Vraja. Revealing His sweetness, He enchants the world.

220 On His left is Śrī Rādhikā with Her *sakhīs*. With them the Lord enjoys the *rāsa* and other pastimes in so many delightful ways.

221 In his own world Brahmā, who is seated on the lotus, meditates on Him and worships Him with the eighteen-syllable mantra.

222 In the fourteen worlds all meditate on Him; in Vaikuṇṭha and the other realms His pastimes and qualities are sung.

223 By His sweetness He attracts even Lakṣmī. Rūpa Gosāñi has described that form:

224 “My friend, if you still delight in the company of your kinsmen, do not look at the form of Hari called Govinda, who stands here near Keśī-tīrtha. He smiles; His body bends in three places; His glance is sidelong and wide; His lips, soft as new leaves, rest on His flute; and He shines with a peacock feather.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.239)

225 He is directly the son of the king of Vraja; there is no doubt about this. If some ignorant person thinks of Him as a mere image,

226 for that offense there is no deliverance for him. He falls into a terrible hell — what more can I say?

227 Who can describe the mercy of the feet of Him by whom I attained such a Lord as Govinda?

228 All the circles of Vaiṣṇavas who live in Vṛndāvana are devoted to the name of Kṛṣṇa and are supremely auspicious.

229 Nityānanda and Śrī Caitanya are the treasure of their lives, and they know nothing but devotion to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa.

230 Lord Nityānanda's mercy gave this fallen soul the dust of those Vaiṣṇavas' feet and the shade of their feet.

231 “There you will attain everything” — these were the Lord's words. That was the *sūtra*, and this has been my explanation of it.

232 Coming to Vṛndāvana, I attained all of that, and all of it was attained by the mercy of this Lord.

233 I write my own story without shame. Nityānanda's qualities drive me mad and make me write.

234 The glory of Lord Nityānanda's qualities is boundless; even Śeṣa, with His thousand mouths, finds no end to it.

235 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.